



# TERMINATOR ON STEROIDS?

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**T**he storyline revolves around humanoid robots called "Hollow Child", which think that they're in fact human (more like grown up versions of Haley Joel Osment's character in AI). When disaster strikes, you, the lead protagonist, Dan Marshall are called upon to save the day along with your squad.

Put simply, this is a third person cover based shooter where you'll progress from point A to point B taking down anything that comes in your way with little scope for deviation. There aren't any real puzzles thrown in to vary the pacing apart from the "pull this lever to go there" scenario.

In terms of gunplay, you'll encounter a plethora of robotic enemies on your way. The enemies are varied in the amount of ammo it takes to take them down. Like most third person shooters these days, Dan carries four weapons: a pistol, two rifles and grenades.

The robotic enemies are a welcome relief from the regular band of soldiers and aliens we've grown accustomed to. Metal flying off robots as you shoot them is a cool effect. You can shoot off their legs or take on that clean headshot, and watch the

robot become a menace to his comrades. The occasional boss battles are anything but satisfying; they can be tedious and frustrating. If you thought games like Deus Ex and Ninja Gaiden required patience with boss battles, you haven't played Binary Domain yet!

The game brings a new element to the third person team-based shooting genre – the ability to issue voice commands to your comrades via a microphone. Or you can hold down "L2".

With comrades always by your side, there's a trust meter that builds up. You can choose to say the right thing and increase it or engage in friendly fire and decrease it.

The graphics aren't the best in its genre but they aren't bad either. The sceneries and environments you visit will give you a glimpse of future Tokyo – a tech-savvy city with some underground resistance thrown into the mix.

The only place where Binary Domain suffers is in its audio production. Hardly any background score for the most part, which is a good thing as the unadulterated sound of bullets tearing through metal and alloy is a lot more satisfying to hear.

So what ruins the game experience? All these effects are washed

down the drain when the cheesy voice acting kicks in. It's hard to relate to any of the characters, the cut scenes are downright silly and there isn't enough substance to keep you hooked. \*

## Verdict

The satisfying feeling of shooting the scrap out of robots comes to an end when the cut scenes and cheesy voiceovers come into play. If you're in the market to pick up a third person shooter, compare the Gears of War trilogy, Vanquish or the Uncharted franchise with Binary Domain before making your purchase decision.

## MOAR!

- » **Developer:** Sega Team CS1
- » **Publisher:** Sega
- » **Genre:** Third Person Shooter
- » **Platforms:** PS3 and Xbox 360
- » **Price:** ₹2,799 (MRP)

